GUIDED CHILDHOOD · PRINT AT HOME

The Calm Down Corner Kit

A cosy corner and a plan,
for the big feeling moments.



8 feelings cards

Star breathing poster

12 calm choice cards

Ages 4 to 9

Pebble and DiGi Junior help your child practise calming down, one small pause at a time. For home and for classrooms.

TEN MINUTES BEFORE THE FIRST BIG FEELING

What a calm corner is, and what it is not

A calm corner is a cosy spot you choose together, in a calm moment, before it is ever needed. A beanbag by the bookshelf. A cushion under the stairs. The carpet corner of your classroom. What makes it work is not the spot. It is the deal: this is where feelings come to get smaller, and your child chooses to go there. It is never a punishment spot. The moment a child is sent there in disgrace, it becomes the naughty step in a nicer jumper, and it stops working.

THE GOLDEN RULE

The corner is where feelings get smaller. It is not where children get sent.

INTRODUCE IT IN A CALM MOMENT

Set it up on an ordinary afternoon when everyone is fine. Let your child choose the cushion and place the cards. Practise the star breathing together once, for fun, like a game. Then, when a big feeling arrives, the corner is already a friend. You are not teaching anything new in the storm. You are pointing at something familiar.

IN THE MOMENT, KEEP IT TINY

Get low, slow your voice, and offer, never order. Try "shall we visit your corner?" If the answer is no, that is allowed. Sit nearby and breathe slowly yourself. Children borrow calm from the adult in the room long before they can make their own. The script card on page eight gives you the exact words.

THE TEN MINUTE SETUP, WITH THINGS YOU ALREADY OWN

1. Pick the spot together. Low traffic, a bit tucked away, never behind a closed door.
2. Add one cushion, one soft toy, and a book or two your child already loves.
3. Put the calm corner sign up at your child's eye height, not yours.
4. Cut out the feelings cards and the calm choice cards, and keep this kit in a folder in the corner.
5. Stick the star breathing poster where a small finger can reach the star.

Teachers: this works as a whole class corner too. One corner, one chair, the same cards. Laminate everything and it will survive the year. This kit helps children practise calming down and builds a calm corner habit. It is a parenting and teaching tool, not a treatment for anything.

A COSY SPOT FOR BIG FEELINGS

My Calm Corner

All feelings welcome here.



Come as you are. Breathe with the star.
Stay until the feeling gets smaller.



PEBBLE KEEPS THIS CORNER SAFE

CUT OUT · KEEP IN A POT OR ON A RING IN THE CORNER

How do you feel right now?

Point to a face, or pick up the card that matches. Naming nothing is fine too. Sometimes holding the card is the whole answer.



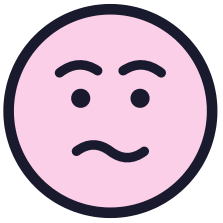
Happy



Sad



Angry



Worried



Frustrated



Tired



Excited



Calm



Pebble says: every face on this page is a friend. There are no bad feelings, only big ones and small ones. We help the big ones get smaller.

Let's breathe together. Put your finger on the green dot and follow me round the star.

Star breathing with DiGi Junior

HOLD... ONE, TWO

BREATHE IN

BREATHE OUT



1. Finger on the green dot. **2.** Trace a side slowly, breathing in through your nose. **3.** Hold still at the point... one, two. **4.** Trace down slowly, breathing out through your mouth. **5.** Keep going all the way round.

Five rounds makes a super calm star. Touch one after each round: ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

CUT OUT · TWELVE THINGS TO TRY WHEN THE FEELING IS BIG

My calm choices

Pick a card. Try it. If it does not help, pick another. There is no wrong choice, only the next thing to try.



Squeeze a cushion tight



Have a drink of water



Count 5 things you can see



Do a big stretch



Ask for a hug



Look at a book



Draw the feeling



Squish some playdough



Listen for 3 sounds



Hold something soft



Rock gently, side to side



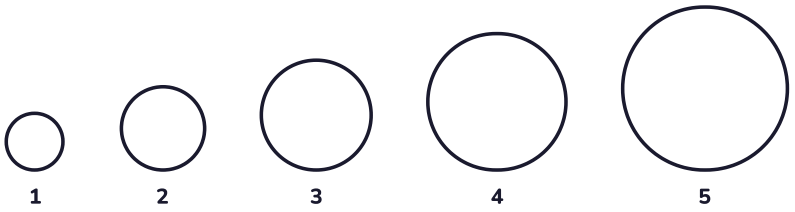
Tell your adult

FOR AFTER · WHEN THE STORM HAS MOSTLY PASSED

The feeling is going

This page is noticing, not homework. A point, a scribble or one word all count. Skip anything. Do it together or not at all.

HOW BIG WAS THE FEELING? COLOUR IT IN.



1 2 3 4 5

Small like a marble, or big like a beach ball. Any size is allowed.

WHAT HELPED? CIRCLE IT.

- Star breathing
- A squeeze
- A drink
- A hug
- A book
- Telling someone
- Something else

ONE THING I WANT MY ADULT TO KNOW

Words, a drawing, or a face from the cards. Anything counts.



Pebble says: you did not get rid of the feeling. You helped it get smaller. That is a real skill, and you just practised it.

FOR THE GROWN UP · CUT OUT AND KEEP IN THE CORNER

What to say when the feeling is big

In the storm, children cannot take in much. Say less than you think you need to, slower than feels natural, and let the corner do the rest.

IN THE MOMENT

You are safe.
I am here.
Let's make the feeling smaller together.

Then offer, never order: "Shall we visit your corner? Do you want the star or the cards?" Get low. Slow your own breathing. If they say no, stay close and wait. Your calm is the loudest thing in the room.

SAVE FOR LATER

That was a big feeling.
You got through it.
What helped?

Never talk about the behaviour until everyone is calm, including you. Teaching lands after the storm, not during it. Later, keep it short and warm, then let it go. The corner stays a safe place, whatever happened before it.

WHY THIS WORKS

A child mid storm is all feeling and no listening. Your first job is not to fix or to teach. It is to be the safe, steady grown up while the feeling passes through. The words on these cards do exactly that job and nothing else. Everything else can wait ten minutes, and it will go better because it waited.

THE GUIDED CHILDHOOD PASSPORT

Your Passport sticker

The Calm Down Corner Kit belongs on the Pebble page (ages 4 to 7), under the talk, in the Guided Childhood Passport. When your family has used the kit, tick it in the Go further strip on that page, then cut out the sticker and stick it on. The big one fits the stage page and the small one fits the fold out passport.



PRINT THIS PAGE ON STICKER PAPER, OR ON PLAIN PAPER WITH A GLUE STICK

No Passport yet? Look for the Guided Childhood Passport in the same Etsy shop: five stage pages for ages 4 to 16, each one stamped when the talk, the doing and the check are done.



A FREE GIFT FOR YOUR FAMILY

As a thank you, the full Guided Childhood Starter Pack is yours free: the star chart, the jobs that earn the stars, and a whole booklet of things to do away from a screen. Pop your email in at the address below and it is yours.

guidedchildhood.com/etsy-bonus

Made by Justin at Guided Childhood, a dad who got tired of the screen time fight. If this kit earns a place in your corner, a kind review on Etsy helps another family find it.